

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1408

By Cepicky

A RESOLUTION to honor Judge Bobby Sands on the occasion of his retirement from the Maury County General Sessions Court.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing our former colleague, Bobby Sands, as he departs the bench; and

WHEREAS, Judge Sands is taking a much-deserved retirement after more than twenty years of hearing cases in Maury County General Sessions Court; and

WHEREAS, Judge Sands has earned the unqualified respect of members of the bar and bench alike during his remarkable tenure, and he has rendered thoughtful service to his peers as President of the Tennessee General Session Judges Conference; and

WHEREAS, Judge Sands began his tenure on the bench in 2005, when he was appointed to serve the unexpired term of one of his mentors, the late General Sessions Judge Jimmy Matthews, and has since been reelected twice without opposition (2014 and 2022); and

WHEREAS, during a distinguished career in private practice that spanned many years, Bobby Sands was an attorney with several firms, in two of which he practiced with his brother, Larry Sands; and

WHEREAS, from 1981 to 1985, he broadened his horizons as Assistant District Attorney for the 22nd Judicial District; he began his judicial career serving as City Judge for the Town of Spring Hill from 1986 to 2000; and

WHEREAS, first elected to the General Assembly in 1996, Judge Sands served three terms in the House of Representatives, ably serving his constituents in District 64 (Maury County), and provided leadership and expertise as Secretary of the House Judiciary Committee; and

WHEREAS, Representative Sands received numerous honors in recognition of his stalwart commitment to the legislative process and the people of Tennessee, including the Tennessee County Officials Association Outstanding Legislator Award and the Tennessee Development Districts Association Legislator of the Year Award; and

WHEREAS, a true servant-leader, Judge Sands has always been active in his profession in a variety of capacities, including service as President of the Maury County Bar Association; and

WHEREAS, he gives back to his community as a member of the American Legion, Maury County Cattlemen's Association, the Advisory Board of First Farmers and Merchants Bank, the First United Methodist Church of Columbia, and the Board of Directors of the Columbia Power and Water Systems; and

WHEREAS, Judge Sands is a past President of the Columbia Kiwanis Club and the Maury County Historical Society and served as a member of the Tennessee Arts Commission during his legislative tenure; and

WHEREAS, in 2022, Judge Sands was recognized by the Tennessee Walking Horse Association for fifty years of service to the Tennessee Walking Horse National Celebration in Shelbyville, including his rousing performances as show-ring announcer from 1984 to 1997; and

WHEREAS, he has received numerous honors and accolades for his dedicated efforts in service of his community, including the George F. Hixson Fellowship and the 1998 Golden K Man of the Year award from the Columbia Kiwanis Club and the 2025 Liberty Bell Award; and

WHEREAS, the recipient of the 2000 Long Rifle Award from the Middle Tennessee Council of Boy Scouts of America, Judge Sands mentored all three of his sons in their quests to attain the highest rank of Eagle Scout; and

WHEREAS, the son of the late Robert Lee and Annie Weatherford Sands, Bobby Sands served as Student Body President during his undergraduate days at Middle Tennessee State University; and

WHEREAS, he then proudly served his country as an officer in the United States Army, 101st Airborne Division; after being honorably discharged from the Army at the rank of First Lieutenant, Judge Sands attended law school at the University of Tennessee, graduating in 1979; and

WHEREAS, his many personal and professional accomplishments aside, Bobby Sands is most grateful for the love and companionship he shares with his wife and love of his life, the former Beth Rambo; their sons and daughters-in-law, David (a pharmacist) and Merideth, Rob (an attorney) and Lee Ann, and Lee (an attorney), who is engaged to be married this summer; and their five wonderful grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, throughout his illustrious tenure on the bench, Judge Sands has exhibited the greatest integrity and a strong commitment to justice, and he is most worthy of our approbation on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor Judge Bobby Sands on the occasion of his retirement after more than twenty years on the Maury County General Sessions Court bench and extend to him our gratitude for a difficult job well done and our best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.

